

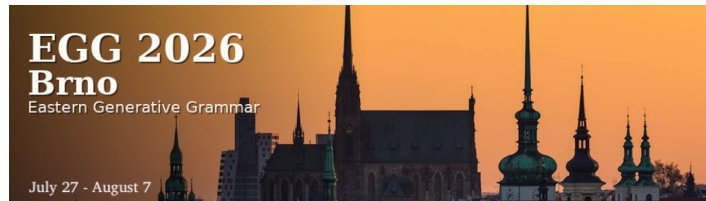


The Functional Architecture of Nominals

Kerstin Hoge

University of Oxford

<https://kxhoge.github.io/resources.html>



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Course outline

Monday	Approaches to the functional structure of nominals
Tuesday	The NP vs. DP debate
Wednesday	The NP vs. DP debate (cont.)
Thursday	Pronouns
Friday	D(emonstrative)-Pronouns

Pronouns

Outline

1. Pronouns as articles / determiners
2. Different pronouns, different structures I
3. Different pronouns, different structures II
4. On the locus and nature of [person]
5. Summary and outlook

Pronouns

Pronouns as articles / determiners

- The traditional conception of pronouns is that they are a closed-class set of (usually) one-word expressions that ‘stand for’ nominals that have more descriptive semantic content.

(1) ‘A Canadian woman of Chinese origin who was interning at Nato’s military headquarters has been arrested ...

She is suspected of spying on behalf of a third country ...’

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Pronouns

Pronouns as articles / determiners

- A common view is thus that pronouns, though they refer, do not describe, which sets them apart from other nominal expressions. Pronouns may then be viewed as ‘the prime instantiation of individual-denoting variables’ (Patel-Grosz & Grosz 2017: 259) whose values are supplied by a linguistic antecedent or the discourse context (subject to constraints imposed by the pronoun’s phi-features).



Pronouns

Pronouns as articles / determiners

- Postal (1969) paves the way for a view of pronouns as having the same syntactic structure (and semantic interpretation) as full nominals.

He argues that English pronouns, rather than realising noun phrases, are ‘types of definite article’ (Postal 1969: 203) that take a pronominal noun *one* as a complement in Deep Structure, which is then deleted in the course of the derivation. The form of the pronominal article is hypothesised to be determined by the feature composition of the pronominal noun.

- (2) a. [NP *he one* [+Pro, + Human, + Definite + Masculine, + III, -II, -I]]
b. [NP *she one* [+Pro, + Human, + Definite + Feminine, + III, -II, -I]]

Pronouns

Pronouns as articles / determiners

- A key piece of Postal's (1969) evidence is the distributional overlap between determiners and pronouns in pronoun-noun constructions.

(3) a. you men
b. you men who wish to escape
c. you great ones

(4) a. the men
b. the men who wish to escape
c. the great ones

Pronouns

Pronouns as articles / determiners

- Postal (1969) rejects an analysis of pronoun-noun constructions as derived from appositive relative clauses (cf. Jespersen 1927), arguing that pronoun-noun constructions not only occur in contexts where appositive relatives may not, but also do not always have appositive meanings.
- (5) a. *Who wrote a novel, which was published by McGraw Hill?
(Postal 1969: 218, ex. (33b))
- b. Who insulted you men?
(Postal 1969: 218, ex. (36b))
- (6) a. You troops will embark but the other troops will remain.
(Postal 1969: 219, ex. (40a))
- b. You, who are troops, will embark but the other troops will remain.
(Postal 1969: 218, ex. (41a))

Pronouns

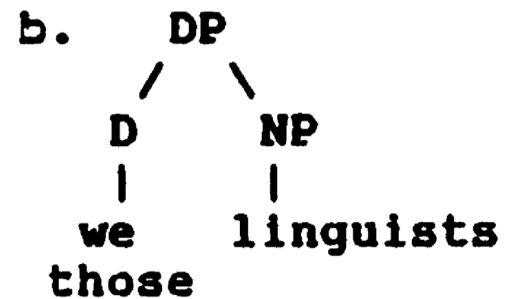
Pronouns as articles / determiners

- Abney (1987) similarly argues for pronouns to instantiate D (rather than N) but departs from Postal (1969) in treating simple pronouns as intransitive determiners.

(7) a.



b.



Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- The hypothesis that personal pronouns are of category D correctly derives the complementary distribution of English pronouns and other elements associated with D.
- (8) a. *the you
b. *this it
c. *which they
- But note that this strict complementarity does not obtain universally.

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- While **Hebrew** first- and second-person pronouns cannot co-occur with the definite article *ha*, third-person masculine / feminine pronouns and impersonal pronouns combine with *ha* to derive distal and proximate demonstratives, respectively.

(9) [Hebrew]

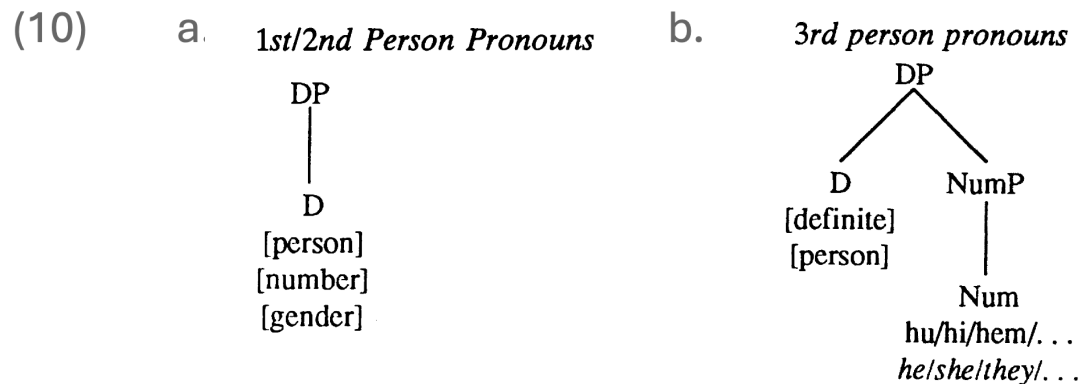
- a. **ha-ani* / **ha-anaxnu*
 **the-I* / **the-we*
- b. **ha-ata* / **ha-at* / **ha-atem* / **ha-aten*
 **the-you(m.sg.)* / **the-you(f.sg.)* / **the-you(m.pl.)* / **the-you(f.pl.)*
- c. *ha-hu/ha-hi* / *ha-hem* / *ha-hen*
 the-he/the-she / *the-they(m)* / *the-they(f)*
 that(m)/that(f)/those(m)/those(f)
- d. *ha-ze* / *ha-zot* / *ha-ele*
 the-it(m)/the-it(f)/the-they
 this(m)/this(f)/these

(Ritter 1995: 420, ex. (20))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- The compatibility of third-person pronouns and definite determiners suggests that the categorial status of Hebrew pronouns is not uniformly D.
- In Ritter's (1995) proposal, 'first and second person pronouns contain only the DP projection, while third person pronouns contain both functional projections DP and NumP':



(Ritter 1995: 420, ex. (21) & 421, ex. (23))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- Ritter (1995) further assumes that the head of each of the projections that make up the nominal phrase (DP, NumP, NP) contributes a different phi-feature:

‘D specifies definiteness, Num is responsible for number, and N gender ...

[I]f a particular category is not projected, the feature it normally bears is specified on the lowest available head’ (Ritter 1995: 422).

Concerning person, Ritter claims that person implies definiteness (but definiteness does not imply person) and that person, like definiteness, is therefore specified on D.

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- The work of Cardinaletti (1994) and Cardinaletti & Starke (1996, 1999) similarly implements the idea that morphologically and syntactically distinct series of pronouns differ in their internal structure.

strong vs. clitic pronouns

- (11) a. Conosco lui / *lo. [Italian]
[I] know him
b. *Lui / lo conosco ____.
(Cardinaletti 1994: 196, ex. (1))

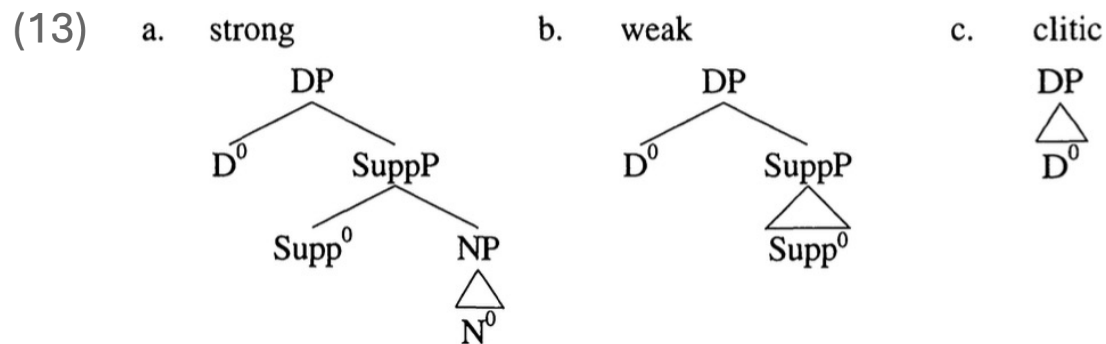
strong vs. weak pronouns

- (12) a. dass ich gestern *ihn / IHN gesehen habe [German]
that I yesterday him seen have
b. dass ich ihn gestern __ gesehen habe
(Cardinaletti 1994: 206, ex. (31))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- Cardinaletti (1994) argues that strong and clitic pronouns differ in internal structure and lexical category:
 - strong pronouns are of category N and raise to D;
 - clitic pronouns are intransitive Ds;
 - weak pronouns contain a ‘morpheme of support’, which incorporates into D, e.g. in German 3.SG.ACC *ihn* ‘him’, [i:] supports the case morpheme *-n* (cf. 3.SG.DAT *ihm*).



(Cardinaletti 1994: 198, ex. (6))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- Evidence for N-to-D movement of strong pronouns is provided by:

- the unacceptability of a definite article + strong pronoun;

(14) a. *i noi b. *il lui
 the we the him
(Cardinaletti 1994: 200, ex. (12))

[Italian]

- strong pronouns having to precede cardinal numerals;

(15) a. noi due b. *due noi c. due amici
 we two two we two friends
(cf. Cardinaletti 1994: 200, ex. (13))

- strong pronouns being able to precede As in exclamatory contexts.

(16) a. Povero lui! b. Povero noi!
 poor him poor us
(Cardinaletti 1994: 200, ex. (15))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures I

- The presence / absence of the lexical projection NP (which distinguishes strong from clitic pronouns) is claimed to derive the different syntactic distribution of the different pronoun types:

‘DPs without a semantic content cannot be moved at LF [Chomsky 1993]; if they do not move in the syntax, a violation of the checking procedure (as far as the Case feature is concerned) would be produced. This means that clitic pronouns, which do not contain the lexical projection NP, must undergo syntactic movement; on the other hand, strong pronouns, which contain the NP projection, do not need to move, hence, according to the minimalist program, they cannot move’ (Cardinaletti 1994: 205).

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

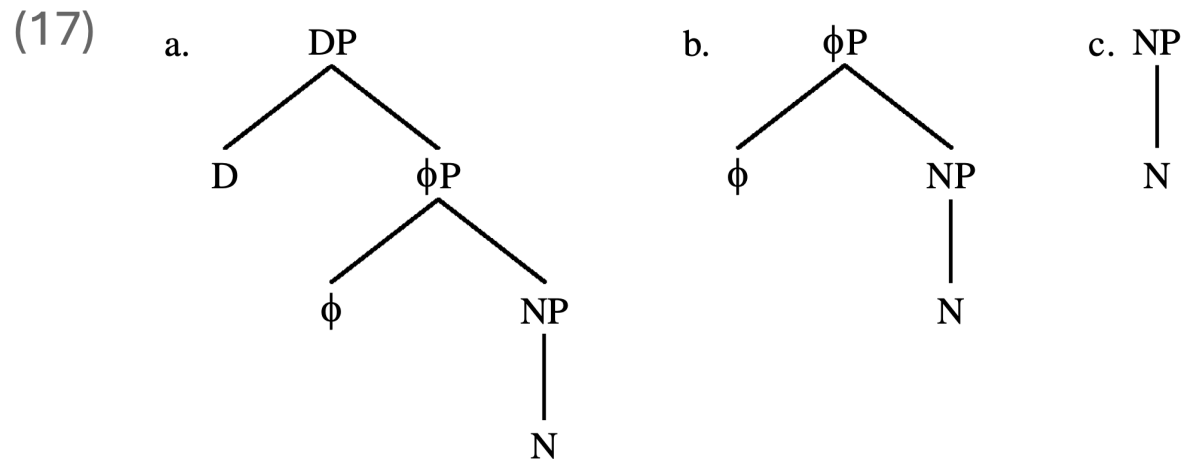
- The approach to derive differences in the (cross- or intralinguistic) syntactic behaviour of personal pronouns from differences in their ***internal*** syntactic structure is criticised by Déchaine & Wiltschko (2002), who question how syntax can ‘see’ the internal structure of pronouns that uniformly project to DP:

‘In other words, attributing internal structural differences does not solve the problem of external differences’ (Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 409).

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Déchaine & Wiltschko (2002) propose that different pronoun types, rather than differing in their internal structure, are projections of different structural height. They distinguish between pro-DPs, pro- ϕ Ps (with ϕ a cover term for any functional projection that encodes phi-features, e.g. Num), and pro-NPs.



(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 410, ex. (1))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- The categorial status of the different pronoun types determines their distribution and their inherent semantics (which in turn determines their binding-theoretic status).

(18) *Nominal proform typology*

	Pro-DP	Pro- ϕ P	Pro-NP
Internal syntax	D syntax; morphologically complex	neither D syntax nor N syntax	N syntax
Distribution	argument	argument or predicate	predicate
Semantics	definite	—	constant
Binding-theoretic status	R-expression	variable	—

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 410, ex. (2))

Pronouns

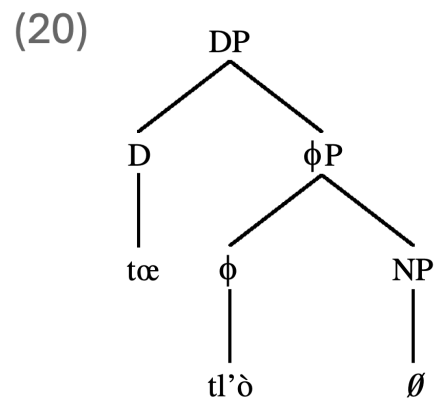
Different pronouns, different structures II

- Cross-linguistic examples of pro-DPs, pro- ϕ Ps and pro-NPs
- **Halkomelem** (Salishan) independent (emphatic pronouns) are pro-DPs.

(19) a. tú-tl'o'
DET-3SG

b. thú-tl'o'
DET.F-3SG

(cf. Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 412, ex. (3))



(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 412, ex. (4))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Internal syntax

(21) Tl'ó-cha-l-su qwemcíwe-t [*thú-tl'ó* *q'ami*]_{ARG}.
then-FUT-1SG-so hug-TRANS DET.FEM-3SG girl
'Then I'm going to hug that girl.' (Galloway 1993:174)

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 412, ex. (5))

[Halkomelem]

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Distribution

- (22) a. [Lám]_{PRED} [tú-tl'ó]_{ARG}.
go DET-3SG
'He goes.' (Galloway 1993:173)
- b. *[Tú-tl'ó]_{PRED}-cha te Bill kw'e may-th-óme.
DET-3SG-FUT DET Bill COMP help-TRANS-2SG.OBJ
intended meaning: 'It will be him, Bill, who helps you.'
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 413, ex. (6))

- (23) a. [Tl'ó]_{PRED}-cha te Bill kw'e may-th-óme.
3SG-FUT DET Bill COMP help-TRANS-2SG.OBJ
'It will be Bill that helps you.' (Galloway 1993:172)
- b. *[Lám]_{PRED} [tl'ó]_{ARG}.
go 3SG
'He goes.'
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 413, ex. (7))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Binding-theoretic status

Halkomelem independent pronouns are subject to Binding Theory Condition C

- (24) *Súq'-t-es [te swíyeqe]_i te kopú-s [tú-tl'ó]_i.
search-TRANS-3.SUBJ DET man DET coat-3.POSS DET-3SG
≠ 'The man_i was looking for his_i coat.' (Wiltschko 1998a:444)
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 414, ex. (9))

... and cannot function as bound variables.

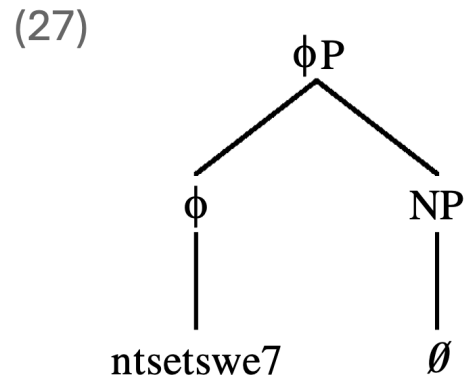
- (25) *[Mékw' ye swíyeqe]_i kw'ákw'ets-et-es te stóles-s [tú-tl'ólem]_i.
every DET.PL man looking-TRANS-3.SUBJ DET wife-3.POSS DET-3.PL
≠ 'All men_i are looking at their_i wives.' (Wiltschko 1998b:445)
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 414, ex. (10))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- **Shuswap** (Salishan) independent (emphatic pronouns) are pro- ϕ Ps.

(26) a. n-tsets-we7 b. 7-enwi7
 1SG-EMPH-DEIC 2SG-EMPH
 (cf. Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 414, ex. (11))



(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 415, ex. (12))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Internal syntax

(28) a. [Wí.w.k-t-Ø-en]_{PRED} [re n-tséts-weʔ]_{ARG}.

see (REDUP)-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-1SG.SUBJ DET 1SG-EMPH-DEIC

‘I saw him.’ (Lai 1998:28, (10))

b. [Wík-t-Ø-s]_{PRED} [re John]_{ARG}.

see-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-3SG.SUBJ DET John

‘S/he saw John.’ (Lai 1998:11, (15))

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 415, ex. (15))

[Shuswap]

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Distribution

- (29) a. [Wí.w.k-t- $\emptyset$ -en]_{PRED} [newí7-s]_{ARG} .
see(REDUP)-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-1SG.SUBJ EMPH-3
'I saw HIM.' (Lai 1998:60, (74a))
- b. [Newí7-s]_{ARG} [wík-t- $\emptyset$ -s]_{PRED} [re Mary]_{ARG} .
EMPH-3 see-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-3SG.SUBJ DET Mary
'HE saw Mary.' (Lai 1998:28, (11c))
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 416, ex. (17))

- (30) [Newí7-s]_{PRED} [re wík-t- $\emptyset$ -m-es]_{ARG} .
EMPH-3 DET see-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-PAST-3SG.CONJ
'It is HIM that saw him/her.' (Lai 1998:28, (13a))
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 416, ex. (16))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Binding-theoretic status

Shuswap independent pronouns are subject to Binding Theory Condition B

(31) Tsut- $\emptyset_i$ m qwetséts- $\emptyset_i$ [newí7-s]_i.

say-3SG.SUBJ PAST leave-3SG.SUBJ EMPH-3

‘He_i said that HE_i left.’ (Lai 1998:31)

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 416, ex. (18))

... and can function as bound variables.

(32) [Xwexwéyt]_i re swet xwis-t- $\emptyset$ -és [newí7-s]_i re qé7tse-s_i.

all DET who like-TRANS-3SG.OBJ-3SG.SUBJ EMPH-3 DET father-3.POSS

‘Everyone_i likes HIS_i father.’ (Lai 1998:32, (21b))

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 416, ex. (19))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- **Japanese** *kare* is a pro-NP.

(33) John_i-ga kare_i-no hahaoya-o nagusameta (koto).
John-NOM he-GEN mother-ACC consoled (NMLZ)
'John_i consoled his_i mother.'
(Hoji 1998: 130, (10b))

(34) NP
|
N
|
kare

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 417, ex. (20))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Internal syntax

- (35)
- a. *tiisai kare*
small he
'he who is small'
 - b. *watasi-no kare*
I-GEN he
'my boyfriend'
 - c. *kono kare*
this he
'this guy here'

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 417, ex. (21))

[Japanese]

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Binding-theoretic status

Kare is undefined with respect to Binding Theory.

As a pro-NP, it (like any noun) has inherent lexical content and thus cannot function as a bound variable

(36) **Daremo*_i-ga *kare*_i-no hahaoya-o aisite-iru.

everyone-NOM he-GEN mother-ACC love-PRES

‘Everyone loves his mother.’ (Noguchi 1997:770, (1a))

≠ $\forall x, x$ loves x ’s mother

(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 417, ex. (22a))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Binding-theoretic status

But *kare* also has referential properties, i.e. a hearer will understand *kare* to refer to a particular person identified in discourse, who is male and of marriageable age.

The referential properties of *kare* allow it to support coreference without giving rise to Binding Theory Condition C effects.

- (37) *John_i-ga kare_i-no hahaoya-o aisite-iru.*
John-NOM he-GEN mother-ACC love-PRES
'John_i loves his_i mother.' (Noguchi 1997:770, (2a))
(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 418, ex. (23a))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

Try your hand at some data analysis

- As previously seen, English pronouns are not uniformly acceptable in the pronoun-noun construction:

- (38) a. we linguists c. us linguists
 b. *they linguists d. ?them linguists

Question 1: What evidence can be adduced for English third-person pronouns instantiating $\text{pro-}\phi\text{P}$?

Question 2: If English third person pronouns are $\text{pro-}\phi\text{Ps}$, which pronoun type must *we* and *us* be analysed as?

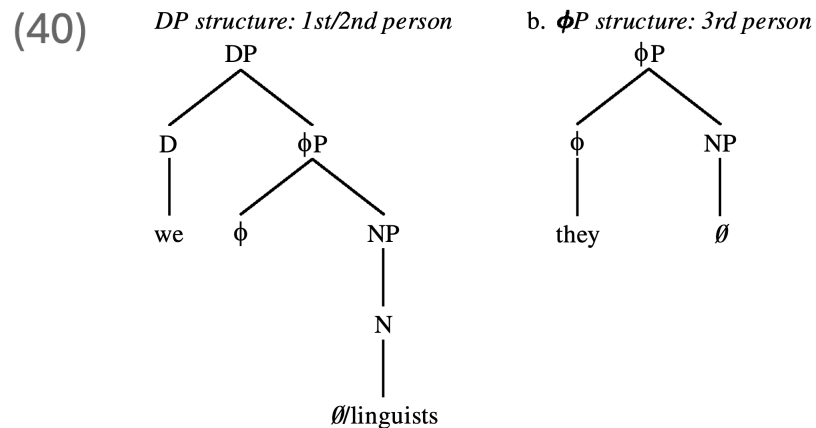
Question 3: Consider the additional data below. Do they shed any light on why *them linguists* is acceptable to some speakers?

- (39) Them linguists, John likes 'em.
 (Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 422, ex. (35b))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

- Since English third-person pronouns can act as bound variables in English (*Every mother loves her child*) and have neither D-syntax (**she linguist*) nor N-syntax (**hungry she*), third-person pronouns must be pro- ϕ Ps in Déchaine & Wiltschko's (2002) typology.
- Déchaine & Wiltschko (2002) propose that first- and second-pronouns (which, being able to occur in the pronoun-noun construction do display D-syntax) are DPs and thus structurally distinct from third-person pronouns.



(Déchaine & Wiltschko 2002: 421, ex. (33))

Pronouns

Different pronouns, different structures II

Try your hand at some data analysis

- For English dialects that allow ?*them linguists*, Déchaine and Wiltschko (2002: 422) suggest that '*them* can be decomposed into a bound D-morpheme *th-* and a clitic ϕ -morpheme *-em*', for which the occurrence of '*em* in *John likes 'em* provides independent evidence.

Pronouns

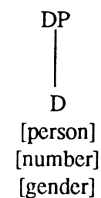
On the locus and nature of [person]

- Both Ritter (1995) and Déchaine & Wiltschko (2002) thus analyse first- and second-person pronouns as structurally distinct from third-person pronouns.

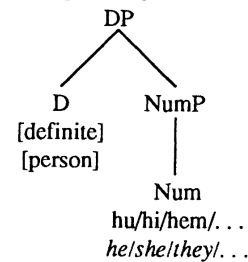
(41)

Ritter (1995)

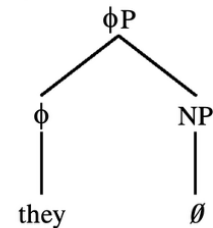
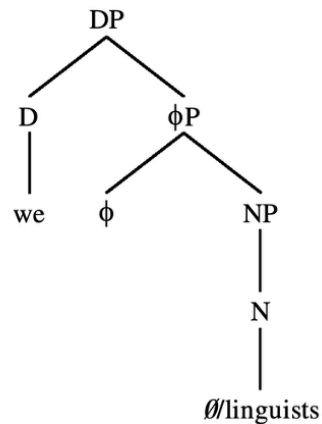
1st/2nd Person Pronouns



3rd person pronouns



Déchaine & Wiltschko
(2002)



Pronouns

On the locus and nature of [person]

- While Ritter (1995) assumes [person] to be specified in D, irrespective of whether the pronoun includes an NP-projection or not, for Dechaine & Wiltschko (2002), [person] is specified within ϕ P for pronouns of all persons.
- The two different views concerning the locus of [person] within nominal structure point to a more fundamental question: What exactly is [person]?

Pronouns

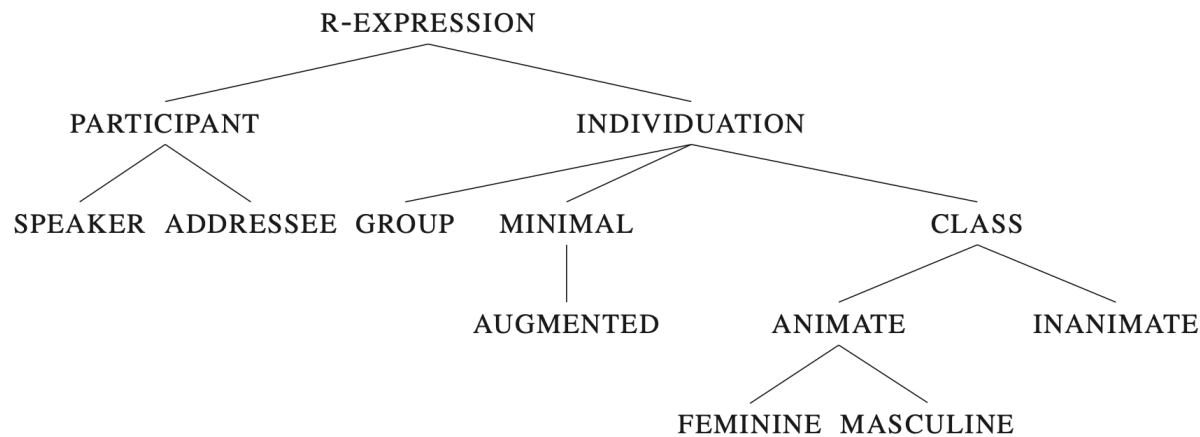
On the locus and nature of [person]

- Seeking to account for the cross-linguistic typology of pronominal systems, Harley and Ritter (2002) propose that the phi-features associated with pronouns are organised into a feature geometry, which groups these features into natural classes and encodes the hierarchical relations between them. The feature geometry is intended to represent the maximal phi-feature structure available in human language.

Pronouns

On the locus and nature of [person]

(42)



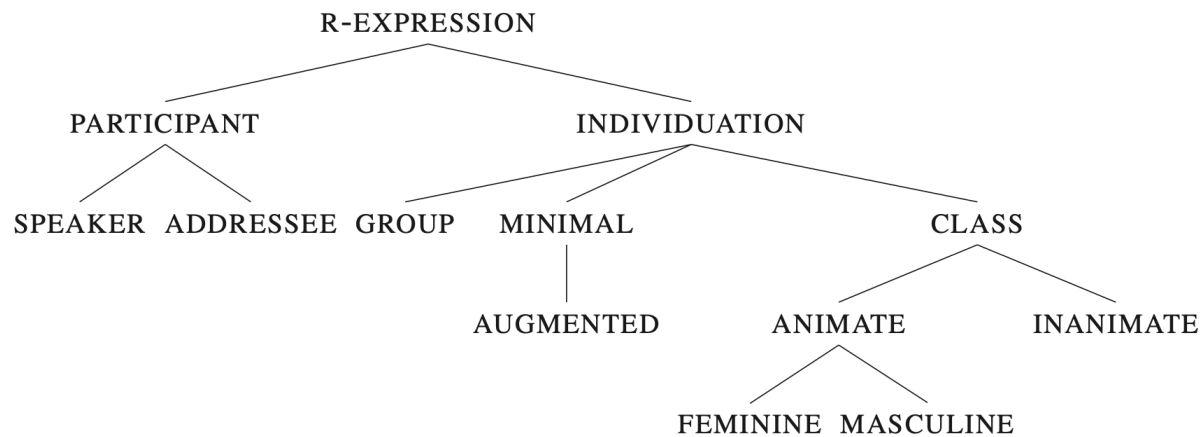
(Harley & Ritter 2002:486)

- Person distinctions are encoded via a node Participant, which dominates Speaker or Addressee, used to distinguish first- from second-person. By organising Speaker and Addressee as dependants of Participant, Harley & Ritter capture first- and second-person as a natural class, distinct from third-person. Third-person is not represented by a dedicated feature (cf. Benveniste 1966) but results from the absence of the Participant node.

Pronouns

On the locus and nature of [person]

(42)



(Harley & Ritter 2002:486)

- Number and gender distinctions are represented under the Individuation node, which dominates the sub-nodes Group, Minimal and Class. Minimal and Group contribute to number distinctions, with Group introducing plurality and Minimal corresponding to non-plural.

Pronouns

On the locus and nature of [person]

- Béjar (2003) embeds Harley & Ritter's (2002) feature geometry into a Minimalist theory of agreement. In much subsequent syntactic work, the decompositional view of person features has been combined with analyses in which person and number project distinct functional heads.

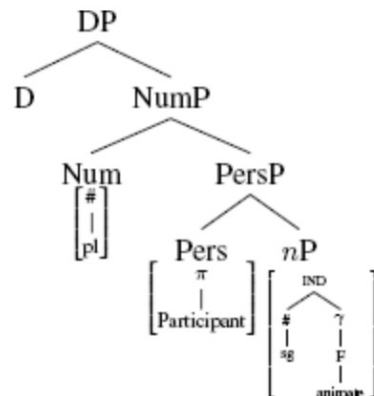
Pronouns

On the locus and nature of [person]

- For example, Puškar-Gallien (2019: 10):

[Concerning person features,] ‘I assume that these are hosted by PersP, which is only projected if it carries a [π :Participant] feature and its dependents, and absent otherwise. Furthermore, I treat the NumP as the locus of grammatical plural number’.

(43) Honorific 2nd person pronoun:



Pronouns

Summary and outlook

- Since Postal's (1969) challenge of the status of pronouns as 'pro-nouns', it has been widely accepted that pronouns instantiate a functional category (whether D or otherwise) in the nominal domain.
- The identification of distinct pronoun types based on morphological, distributional, and semantic evidence has led to syntactic accounts in which pronouns differ in their underlying structure. These accounts fall into two broad groups: one maintains that pronouns differ internally but uniformly project as DPs, while the other holds that pronouns differ in their categorical identity.
- If personal pronouns are syntactic objects of varying sizes, how does this typology extend to other classes of pronouns which are used in similar contexts?

(44) Maria hat einen netten Nachbarn. Er / der gießt im Sommer ihre Blumen.
Maria has a nice neighbour. he_{PERS} / he_{DEM} waters in summer her flowers.
'Maria has [a nice neighbour]_i. He_i waters her flowers in the summer.'
(Patel-Grosz & Grosz 2017: 260, ex. (4))

Pronouns

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